IIMA VENTURES / CIIE.CO AND GUSEC

Institutional backing for a founder-built venture

UrbanKhet's incubation, seed support and recognition through the Indian innovation ecosystem.

Role: Founder seeking incubation and investment | Period: 2019–2021

Reported outcomes and scope

CIIE.CO incubation and seed support

Reported institutional backing for UrbanKhet.

TIDE 2.0 + SSIP

Reported innovation grants, separate from an academic degree.

The product problem

An early venture needs capital and credibility while the business model is still being proved. A founder has to explain the customer problem, the operating model and the economics in a way that institutions can evaluate.

My role

I led UrbanKhet's incubation and fundraising process. The records describe institutional support through IIM Ahmedabad Ventures / CIIE.CO, alongside GUSEC and public innovation programmes.

What I built

The documented path includes incubation and seed investment, with mentorship around go-to-market, pricing and operating scale. TIDE 2.0 and Gujarat SSIP support are recorded as grants.

Atal Innovation and Most Promising Startup recognition form part of the venture record. The product work and customer operation remain the underlying business, while these programmes provided institutional support around it.

What changed

The sources support incubation, seed backing and the named grants and recognition. They do not provide a reliable consolidated funding amount. Incubation is presented as venture development rather than an IIM academic qualification or employment role.

The lesson from this work

This case demonstrates a founder’s ability to make an operating business legible to investors and support institutions. Capital, grant support and recognition are distinct forms of backing and retain their separate meanings.

Visual references and walkthroughs

UrbanKhet: generated editorial illustration of the farm-to-fork model

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View the online case study for the full image gallery and playable videos.

Evidence and attribution

No exact funding total is claimed. This was founder incubation, not an IIM degree.